

NAIROBI SCHOOL 2025 PREDICTION



KCSE ANTICIPATION EXAM



101/2

ENGLISH

PAPER 2

(Comprehensive, Literary Appreciation and Grammar)

TIME: 2½ HOURS

NAME.....

SCHOOL..... SIGN.....

INDEX NO..... ADM NO.....

(Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education)

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

- *Write your name and index number in the spaces provided.*
- *Answer **ALL** the questions in this question paper.*
- *All your answers must be written in the spaces provided in this question paper.*

For Examiners Use Only

Question	Maximum score	Student's score
1	20	
2	25	
3	20	
4	15	
Total score	80	

1. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

Everyone has struggled with lack of confidence at one time or another. More so, confidence that may have been built over the years may be lost when we face new challenges, make mistakes, fall or receive criticism. It is probable that one of the most common wishes for many people is to feel more confident in various spheres of life. Building confidence must be something you want for yourself and not just for appearance's sake. Confidence is beneficial in business, at the work place, in your social life, and even in your interpersonal relationships. It can make the difference between success and failure in business, getting a promotion or a pay rise, meeting someone interesting at a party, and even successfully disciplining your children when you become a parent.

Some people have a higher level of confidence than others, but this should not discourage those who lack it. Like many things in life, confidence can be learned and even perfected. Most people have areas in their lives where they could be more confident and thus have better results. There are various practical ways about building confidence. However, these are not necessarily quick fixes or overnight solutions. Building confidence should happen gradually over a period of time.

Spending time thinking about how little confidence you have is not helpful and will only discourage you more. It may be easier said than done, but working on something and getting it done is a useful confidence builder. Stop relying on your feelings and spring into action. Dale Carnegie, a famous American writer, once said that, 'Inaction **breeds** doubt and fear. Action breeds confidence and courage. If you want to conquer fear, do not sit at home and think about it. Go out and get busy.'

Facing your fears is another confidence builder. Begin by recognizing that many fears are based on misjudgements and wrong perceptions. Yes, even your memory about something may be skewed and inaccurate, making you believe something that is actually not true. You should learn to develop a healthy curiosity filled with anticipation and enthusiasm about various situations and tasks you have been fearful of. With time, it will enable you to be more open to experience and put less focus on your fear.

Lack of preparation is a big source of low self-confidence. You have no idea what to expect, and this makes you fear the unknown. You are not sure what you are afraid of. Most of the times, low self-confidence can be solved by adequate preparation. Be aware what to expect and how to deal with whatever is at a hand.

Confidence does not really come assured of success. It also comes from knowing that failure is not the end of the world. Failure never feels good, but it gives us valuable lessons, if we are keen enough to learn. Failure makes us stronger. Again, remember that not everyone is busy monitoring your every success or failure. They are too **preoccupied** with their own issues. Therefore, do not spend too much time thinking what people will say about your failure.

Despite being aware of what makes you lack confidence and how to build it, confidence will not always come naturally. Sometimes, you have to '**fake it till you make it.**' You may have to face intimidating situations head on while telling yourself that you are ready for them, even when you know that you do not feel that way. This may go a long way in helping you to actually feel confident. Interestingly, the people who may regard you as more confident than you could also be using this technique. Also, consider your strengths and recognize the fact that just like everyone else, you have something to offer.

QUESTIONS.

a. Why does the author say that we should build our confidence? (3 marks)

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b. Why should one not compare themselves with others? (2 marks)

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c. How does developing a healthy curiosity enable you to develop confidence? (2 marks)

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d. Make notes on the practical ways in which one can build their confidence. (4 marks)

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e. What is the author’s attitude towards the subject matter? (3 marks)

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f. Like many things in life, confidence can be learned and even perfected. (Rewrite the sentence beginning:
Confidence ...) (1 mark)

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g. How does the writer reassure those who lack confidence?

(2 marks)

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h. Explain the meaning of the following expressions as used in the excerpt.

(3 marks)

1. Breeds _____
2. Preoccupied _____
3. Fake it till you make it _____

2. Read the excerpt below and answer the questions that follow.

Mossi: Far from the truth! Take the issue of development, for example. Everywhere in *The Samaritan*, I am being accused of inflating the cost of projects and presiding over shoddy Municipal works. Am I indeed responsible for that?

Nicole: Maybe it is because you are the overall leader. The buck stops with you, as they say.

Mossi: Oh, yes, it's easy to think so because I am the overall custodian of the public good in our Municipality. But take any project, such as the construction and maintenance of secondary roads in our town. Are any roads ever constructed? I will tell you what happens. Only a few kilometres of road are usually dug up and then levelled. Then the contractor pours old black oil and claims the road is tarmacked. Today, our secondary roads look like part of an abandoned battlefield where bombs were detonated. Even tractors can get stuck in those roads! Yet, the Council pays top dollar for these roads each year! Am I responsible?

Nicole: Tell me, Your Worship.

Mossi :(*Standing up and pacing about at the boardroom*) It is my Deputy! That irredeemable gossip and broker! As you know, he doubles up as our Municipal Secretary for the Department of Physical infrastructure. He uses this position to ensure only his companies or those of his relatives win tenders for road construction in our Municipality. The same happens with regard to tenders for the construction of bridges, pavements, drains and watercourses. Sadly, they don't do any meaningful work! They simply misappropriate the funds!

Nicole : So, what does that have to do with the people?

Mossi : Doesn't bother you that the people overwhelmingly voted for this kind of a person knowing very well he has never accomplished anything in his life other than swindle the people?

Nicole: Oh, did they know?

Mossi: Of course, they did! There is hardly any person he has not conned in this town! You always find him leaning on the street poles in our town's backstreets, gazing vacantly into empty spaces like an evil Spirit — waiting for fake title deeds to be printed. He prints ten title deeds for the same plot, and then sells the same plot to ten different people. Yet the people went ahead and voted for him! Why do the people glorify evil and mediocrity, and then turn and whine when it hurts them? And you know what?

a) Place this excerpt in its immediate context. (4 marks)

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b) Mayor Mossi claims that Hon. Ramdaye has conned almost everyone in their town. Mention one Council leader who has been conned and explain how. (2 marks)

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c) Discuss two themes raised in the excerpt. (4 marks)

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d) Identify two-character traits of each of the following characters brought out in the excerpt. (4 marks)

(I)Hon. Ramdaye

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(II) Mossi

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e) Identify three stylistic techniques the writer has employed in the excerpt. (6 marks)

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f) Everywhere in The Samaritan, I am being accused of inflating the cost of projects and presiding over shoddy Municipal works. Rewrite replacing the underlined word with a phrasal verb) **(1 mark)**

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g) From elsewhere in the text, why has Mayor Mossi met Teacher Nicole? **(2 marks)**

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h) Explain the meanings of the following words used in the excerpt. **(2 marks)**

- I) Inflating _____
- II) Misappropriate _____

3. Read the oral poem below and answer the questions that follow.

Weakened and weeping, I remain among the ruins.
Weakened and weeping, I remain amid trackless plains.
Tell me, what is this place where I remain?
By my father's name, with whom do I remain?
They dwindle, the people, the unworthy ones stay on.
They dwindle, the people, unworthy one stay on.
They dwindle, the people, with whom do we remain?
Weakened and weeping, I remain among the ruins.
When the sun has sunk under the earth
I go to the door,
I go stealthily and on tiptoe:
I imagine he is coming,
I imagine he comes carefree from the hunt.

They die, do the people, with whom do we remain?
They die, do the people, we remain among the ruins.
They die, do the people, we remain amid trackless plains.

a) Classify the above oral poem giving reason. (2 marks)

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b) Who is the persona in this oral poem? (2 marks)

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c) Identify and illustrate one function of the above oral poem. (2 marks)

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d) Identify, illustrate and state the effectiveness of any two features of style used in this oral poem. (6 marks)

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e) Describe the tone of the oral poem. (3 marks)

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f) Give two ways in which the anxiety of the singer is brought out. (2 marks)

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g) Identify and illustrate one economic activity in this oral poem. (2 marks)

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h) Explain the meaning of the following words as used in the oral poem. (2 marks)

i) Dwindle _____

ii) Stealthily_____

4.

a. Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. (4 marks)

i. My aunt was sick for a month. Her personal physician advised her to take some time off her busy engagements. (Begin using: Having...)

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ii. It started to drizzle as soon as we started our exams. (Begin: Hardly...)

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iii.‘Why do you always come late to work?’ the supervisor asked Waridi. ‘This is no longer acceptable.’
(Rewrite in indirect speech)

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iv. This is the girl. Her project is thriving. (Join into one sentence using a relative pronoun)

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b. Complete the following sentences with the correct preposition. (3 marks)

- i. Young one, get _____ the wet all immediately.
- ii. The telephone is _____ the window.
- iii. Students are normally given a certificate _____ completion of the course.

b. Fill in the blank spaces with the correct form of the word in brackets. (4 marks)

- i. This equipment has _____ idle since the company closed. (lay)
- ii. Have you _____ out the washing? (hang)
- iii. Do not wait for the bus, it comes to town very _____ (regular).
- iv. The kitchen staff was accused of _____ by the caterers. (subordinate)

c. Complete the sentences below with the correct collective noun. (3 marks)

- i. The _____ of quails flew away.
- ii. A _____ of peacocks is beautiful to watch.
- iii. A _____ of monkeys can be destructive.

d. Complete the following sentences using an appropriate question tag. (1 mark)

- i. Please smile, _____?

THE END